



THE FIGHT FOR AMERICA'S FAMILIES

Exposing the Corruption in Family Courts and CPS.

They took my kids. They tried to silence me. They WON'T.

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 28

NORTH CAROLINA

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — a cross-location dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside North Carolina's family courts and child-welfare system.

215

NORTH CAROLINA FAMILIES ON
RECORD · 384 CHILDREN IMPACTED ·
17 MONTHS MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF
PARENTING TIME

REPORT GENERATED

JULY 4, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED

64 OF 100

COMPILED BY

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS · NORTH CAROLINA

A name appears below only after 3 or more independent families have named the same actor in North Carolina. Submitter names, emails, and contact details are never published. Comments below are direct family reports — one per family — with all identifying information removed.

Shy-Kendra Lawson

CPS WORKER · LENOIR · 6 SUBMISSIONS

"Shy-Kendra Lawson delayed reunification and failed to properly support kinship placement despite an approved relative option and my continued requests for my children to be safely placed with family. Cleaner, stronger version for the form, because apparently forms want trauma squeezed into one tiny bureaucratic sentence: Shy-Kendra Lawson delayed reunification, failed to support approved kinship placement, and contributed to my children remaining in foster care instead of being placed with safe family."

"Made or relied on false and misleading claims, ignored evidence in my favor, and supported keeping my child in foster care."

"Delayed reunification by interfering with visitation and failing to support reasonable family placement options."

LENOIR COUNTY SOCIAL SERVICES

"Lied under oath, not following guidelines set beforehand"

"Told me lies, laughed at me humiliated me several times"

"Great experience. Would recommend."

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-shy-kendra-lawson/complaint-packet>

Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Tammy Smith

ATTORNEY (OPPOSING) · HARNETT · 6 SUBMISSIONS

"She was texting the judge from a personal number during the hearing about the hearing itself. He would check his phone after every single text she sent in the court room. And they would lock eyes and nod."

"Refused to make copies (in the chambers) of evidence that the trial judge Rose asked, continued to question myself about My spouse but would not subpoena My spouse to ask the questions." HARNETT COUNTY

"Weird stuff going on in this county with this lawyer and judge Kimble. The case showed obvious partiality towards Tammy and her client."

"Delay after delay. Inappropriate with the judge" HARNETT COUNTY

"Inappropriate relationship with the judge."

"Babs sndjdbd Anshan Anshan"

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-tammy-smith/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED**Cindy Cronkhite**GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · LENOIR COUNTY COURTHOUSE · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

"Provided or relied on false and misleading information while ignoring evidence supporting reunification and my relationship with my child. Appeared to favor the foster placement while minimizing my parental bond, my evidence, and reunification efforts. Cindy failed to fully investigate my child's best interests, ignored key evidence, and supported continued separation from me."

"Submitted reports and recommendations that ignored key evidence supporting reunification, including my negative drug screens, approved kinship placement, and concerns about visits being suspended. Cindy Cronkhite failed to include important facts in GAL reports, did not support safe family placement, and contributed to continued separation from my children."

"Nothing she has done has been in the best interest of the children, she has kept the mother from seeing her girls as well as been untruthful"

"Supported agency recommendations that limited reunification, visitation, and family placement efforts."

*"Lied under oath, deprived mothers visits." **LENOIR***

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-cindy-cronkhite/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED**Duchess Chance**GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · BEAUFORT COUNTY · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

"She was my GAL. I reported abuse to her which she did nothing about. I reported my money was being held by DSS from my job and she did nothing. I reported Abby Williams making me write a statement she was giving and spelling words for me and she did nothing. I told her the truth about my parents and why I kept trying to go home to them but it was never reported. She wouldn't allow me to see my siblings. She came to locked facilities I was in and told me I had to stay because there was no where else for me but there was. I had more family in WV willing to take me. I was also 17. She allowed dss to keep me out of school which delayed my graduation and threw me behind. She lied on her court report stating she saw and spoke with me each week and I barely saw her or spoke to her. She told a judge it wasn't in my best interest to speak with him and tried to quash my subpoena to testify from my mother's attorney when I specifically kept asking to speak with a judge. She at one point told me I was nothing but trouble to her."

"Falsified her reports to the judge. Did not visit or talk with the children as reported. Allowed children's visits with abuser to continue even after she struck children on several occasions and children were refusing visits she made them attend stating it is an order and you and your dad will be in trouble with the judge if you do not go. She allowed contact with siblings to be severely restricted. She allowed one child's paydays to go to the social worker with him never seeing those wages again. She did not show up to juvenile court when child had ran away from abusive placement and dss was trying to have him charged for disorderly conduct. She did not help in getting his picture released to search for him. She did no advocacy for the children. She and lead social workers are friends and do a podcast online about wine outside of work. She was not neutral. She also did not respect DVPO in place with the parents." **BEAUFORT COUNTY**

"She only becomes involved and advocates when it is convenient for her. Contradicted herself multiple times on whether removals impact children dependent on what fits the current narrative. Does not advocate independently but clearly makes recommendations in conjunction with DSS. Even if it is not in the best interest of the child."

"Lied to my children repeatedly. Participated in letting my daughter think I didn't want her home. Said she only "has" to speak to my children once every 90 days. Has hung up on my grandmother before and me as well. Her GAL reports are filled with lies and inconsistencies." **BEAUFORT**

"Believe everything child said"

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-duchess-chance/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Jennifer Eichorn COURT CLERK / COURT STAFF · LENOIR COUNTY COURTHOUSE RECOVERY COURT COORDINATOR · 5 SUBMISSIONS

"Jennifer Eichorn provided questionable drug test documentation, including a positive result before a sample was submitted, which affected my visitation. She lied on a lot of parents and treated them badly."

"Presented a positive drug test result before I gave a urine sample, causing my visitation and reunification progress to be harmed."

"Provided disputed positive drug test results that were used to delay reunification and prevent family restoration."

"coordinator for recovery court falsified drug tests to prevent parents from reunification with their children" **LENOIR COUNTY**

"Saying I got to do group twice a week"

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-jennifer-eichorn/complaint-packet>

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Jonathon Sargeant

JUDGE · LENOIR COUNTY COURTHOUSE · 5 SUBMISSIONS

"Judge Johnathan Sargeant ignored my due process concerns and allowed the case to proceed without fully addressing pending constitutional, ADA, visitation, and placement issues. Judge Johnathan Sargeant laughed at me in open court with the GAL attorney and CPS attorney while comments were made in front of the courtroom audience suggesting I did not know who my children's fathers were, despite the fact that I had provided that information. He laughed during my hearing with opposing attorneys after they made a humiliating statement about my children's fathers, then failed to meaningfully hear my evidence and due process concerns."

"Ignored evidence, denied due process, prevented reunification without evidence Ignored evidence, went along with whatever CPS claimed without giving me a chance to defend myself, no due process."

"Judge Jonathan Sargeant failed to meaningfully address evidence, due process concerns, DSS misconduct, visitation issues, and reunification efforts, allowing my child to remain in foster care." **LENOIR**

"Denied motion, laughed claiming I did not know who my child's father was, denied kinship allowing them to stay in CPS custody after ICPC was approved" **LENOIR COUNTY**

"Laughed at mother in middle of court over paternity issues, doing whatever dss suggests without reason." **LENOIR**

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-jonathon-sargeant/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED**Latesha Boseman**CPS WORKER · BEAUFORT · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

"She had me placed in locked facilities without a court order because I wanted to speak to a judge and kept running away from bad homes they placed me in. She refused to report the abuse in the last facility I was in. She took my paydays from my job and I never received the funds back. She cancelled my dental surgery 3 times so almost a year later when my mom could get it done I had curved roots around my jaw and had to be cut more with a longer recovery time. She lied to me saying my family didn't want to see me. She wouldn't allow me to go to my church in the community. She wouldn't allow me to see my siblings. She frequently would take my personal belongings, many of which I've never gotten back, esp my cellphone. She would t allow me to go to my family in WV even tho I was wanted there. She lied on the stand about my behaviors. She lied on the stand saying I never told her I wanted to go home and stated I was afraid of my father. I watched her get really close to my mother when she told Latesha you will not speak to my son that way and Latesha told her what are you going to do about it? He's in our custody and he will do what we say. She would allow me to have no contact even with mys school or peers when I was telling of the abuse in the places she put me. That's when I was moved to a facility out of my community 2 hours away and taken from school completely with no schooling being done."

"Falsified reports to GAL and judge. Placed one son in facilities without a court order. Restricted access to children with parents, family, and siblings. Took personal possessions from children. Took paydays of one teenage son which he has never seen to this day. Perjured herself on the stand regarding missing son and efforts made and he came to be in a facility with no court order. Followed and stalked our family. Got physically aggressive with me personally saying and what are you gonna do about it? Refused to follow the court order and restricted parents access to medical and educational records, events, Dr appts, and had medication changed without parents knowledge or consent. Refused to follow a DVPO in place making parents be in a room with their abuser and not respecting the fear and concerns they had with the abuser. Placed children with abuser when visits were reported of going badly to the point social Workers had to intervene and children tried to refuse visits and she made them go anyway. Children were struck at visits with their mother but visits were not stopped nor did social worker do anything to the mother."

"She has proven to be very power hungry. Has admitted that she does not like children, publicly. It is abundantly clear that she acts out of emotion and malice, and not professionally. In turn, this becomes priority, not the welfare of the children. She does not act in their best interest."

"Has a record that entails she should be nowhere near making decisions for the well-being of children. Has enabled the abuse of Audrey Faith Bell (social worker). Also lied to my 15 year old daughter regarding her coming home."

"Supervisor of foster care that has multiple criminal offenses including armed robbery and domestic violence."

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-latesha-boseman/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED**Lori Leggett**CPS WORKER · BEAUFORT · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

"She is the director. I kept asking to speak to someone because I wasn't allowed to see my family at all. She also told me my family did not wish to see me right now and no one was willing to take me. I later found this to not be true as many family members, my girlfriend, and even my friends had asked to see me and some to take me in. I also told her what Abby Williams had wrote and said in court was not true and she just kept saying I know her and she would not lie. It's like it didn't matter what I said. Lori Leggett is also who made me go to the first locked facility saying it was there or she would go for a petition to have me placed in juvie. I reported the abuse to her also at one facility and she did nothing. I also told her I did not like sleeping in their office and their couches weren't even long enough to hold me and she said I could always make a bed on the floor. She does not care."

"There is a gross lack of oversight based on her lack of knowledge of decisions and actions being taken by her own employees. When challenged she hides behind very general statements vs. taking accountability for their actions."

"She's the director. She has been stealing children for 25 years now, I will run out of room in this box to name everything she has allowed to happen."

"Signed off on paperwork and acts like she has no knowledge of title 4e and 4d funding" **BEAUFORT COUNTY**

"No license ingores us" **BEAUFORT COUNTY**

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-lori-leggett/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED**Ward Scott**JUDGE · BUNCOMBE · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

*"Ward exhibited clear bias from the inception of the case; sustained every objection to all my evidence of harm and trauma caused to my children by their father, then told me, "Looks like you have no evidence of any of this. I find you unbelievable," threatened to imprison me if I did not reveal the name of my attorney who advised me to flee this jurisdiction to keep my boys safe, then decided I was lying when I refused to give him the name; violates many of the Rules of Judicial Procedure but threatened to sanction me when I pointed this out; pretended not to understand what a conflict of interest was, and decided that the wisest action to take to determine the existence of a conflict was for *the conflicted person* to make this determination; withheld that he had a conflict of interest due to his former employment with NC's DSS, even after I mentioned numerous times that DSS behaved unethically and perhaps illegally, and that I've been told that DSS is trying to harm me; has a fantastical ego that is a major danger to anyone entering family court in Buncombe County, particularly if you are a woman and your children have suffered abuse caused by a man."*

"Terminated my parental rights and they called me to court that morning without notice and I was in class at the local technical College not sure why I wasn't informed on this hearing that I knew NOTHING ABOUT"

"He laughed when he saw an evidence photo of a hole punched in a door by my ex, then looked at my ex and said "you know they make keys, don't you?""

"Ignored Evidence"

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-ward-scott/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED**Abigail Williams**CPS WORKER · BEAUFORT · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

"She yelled at my mother at the hospital telling her she was an irresponsible mother and didn't deserve her children. She refused to leave my hospital room until the Dr made her when I was throwing an absolute fit. This was before any safety plan or order done. She made me leave my mother that night even tho I just wanted to go home. Two days later she wouldn't let me leave a room at DSS until I finished writing a statement which she was telling me what to write and gave spelling for words as I struggle. That letter was also back dated by two days. She lied in the order she got signed by Regina Parker. She has statements in there I never said. She would not allow me to see my family at all for a month. Then it was only my mother even tho I asked for my dad and siblings. She told me my family did not want to see me and I found out later that was a lie and my family both close and in WV had reach out to see and speak with me as well as my girlfriend."

"She threatened me while at the hospital with my son. Refused to leave his room even when asked. Yelled at me in front of my son and hospital staff. (Recorded) Falsified her records to obtain non secured custody. Laughed in court when I asked that they show evidence because I was due a 7-10 hearing and they had continued it and never had to show any proof. Approached my teenage son telling him I was a horrible parent and not meeting his needs. Spoke with our pastor telling it was proven we were abusive parents. Spoke with our children's school telling them they were forbidden to speak with us as we had no rights to our children at this time." **BEAUFORT COUNTY**

"Perjury and lied to have my kids removed a out the condition of my house. Worked with the town to have my utilities cut off so she could remove my kids. Dss never stepped foot in my home to confirm the condition of my home She also tried to have a surgery preformed on my son who is a cardiac paitient without the approval of his cardiologist"

"She perjured herself many times on the stand. Lied during intake, has lied repeatedly. There are MANY families she has wronged."

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-abigail-williams/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Daphne Bacon

GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE / ATTORNEY / GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · BEAUFORT · 4 SUBMISSIONS

"She never spoke with any of the children but was a supervisor who began to attend meetings in Duchess Chances place when I began to complain she was not speaking up for the children nor visiting with them or respecting the DVPO in place with the parents. She told me all I did was cause chaos around me (recorded) after I was placed in a waiting room alone with my abuser. She stated until you are done what you are told you will not see your children. This was 7 months in with not a single hearing being had." **BEAUFORT COUNTY**

"I reported that Duchess Chance was not listening to me and allowing abuse and me to be placed in locked facilities. She didn't report the abuse either. I reported Latesha had taken my money from my job yet it was never returned. I reported my cellphone had been taken and I wasn't allowed to talk to my family I reported I wanted to see my family but she did nothing to help and said she was told they didn't want to see me. It was all untrue. They tried to isolate me."

"Never advocated. Then at a crucial point where advocacy was needed she did not do so. When challenged in oversight she has a very adversarial return and does not act appropriately or in a professional manner."

"Followed me to my car during open court and took pictures of the vehicle."

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-daphne-bacon/complaint-packet>

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H. Jay White, Sr.

ATTORNEY · CABARRUS COUNTY · 4 SUBMISSIONS

"Says things that aren't true and is either allowing DSS to lie or telling them to lie. He's the most powerful man in Cabarrus County no one will go against him. He's asking me to stop taking my prescribed medication that I've been taking for over 20 years and the foster mom is on the same medication and is allowed to care for our children but he's stating I can't."

"He represents all Dhs cases and still does and he lies and falsified papers" **CABARRUS COUNTY**

"<https://recorder.google.com/d429d183-e30f-4023-b14a-f071dfe0a70>"

"Withheld evidence" **CABARRUS**

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-h-jay-white-sr/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED**Jason Williams**JUDGE · BEAUFORT COUNTY · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

"I want to start by saying I think this man was trying to work the good ol boy system to bring about change and fight for parents the best way he knew how within that system. I think advocating for me and parents like me is what cost him his judges seat in the last election. That being said he still signed orders that were unconstitutional and allowed in lies without the parents ever getting to speak or present evidence. He allowed us to be silenced and blocked. He allowed delays. He allowed full hearings against my teenage son without my son ever being notified or present knowing my son ran claiming abuse. He allowed back door meetings in his chambers without us as parents being represented or our children. He did give unlimited visitation with our parents present and all rights to appointments to be present and have records and our children to be able to contact one another freely. He had a responsibility though to say it was illegal and abolish it but he chose not to. He did so trying to hold that seat n still lost it because he was playing both sides."

"He would accept no proof or documentation from my mother. He violated due process and kept continuing hearings for DSS. In my juvenile case started by DSS he held full hearings without me being present or notified. He signed an order for my property ordering that my mother get this items or be jailed. He refused to investigate my claims of abuse at the facility I ran from. He turned a blind eye to me being placed in locked facilities without reason because I was speaking out about the care I received and the abuse. He did not report that abuse either to the authorities."

"At the time he was my court appointed attorney. Failed to file any motions and misrepresentation"

"He signed and reinforced the unconstitutional seizure of my children, after the fact."

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-jason-williams/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED**Judge Kimble**JUDGE · HARNETT COUNTY · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

"He dragged the case out over months and months because he kept claiming he didn't have time to listen to the testimonies. It cost our family tens of thousands of dollars. He claimed he lost his notes and extended the case yet another day for the father to say his piece all over again. Pushed and pushed his decision as far as he possible could. The father had zero case against the mother. All his accusations were proved false. The entire thing was weird and suspicious and showed favoritism towards the father. Justice was not served. Seemed the entire time the judge did not give a care at all about the case." **HARNETT**

"Very inappropriate comments during the trial. He joked about himself not knowing when to stop drinking alcohol - knowing that he was arrested for a DUI from picking up his kids from school. He also was talking inappropriately with the attorney - he allowed heresay numerous times for her client. Didn't ask for proof. Discarded all evidence of her client being abusive and neglected to make a ruling several times until it was far enough out to claim comfort."

"Ruled on emergency ex parte, never had an emergency hearing. Took my son from me with no evidence Made a ruling with no evidence. Left child with abuser. Took months and months to make a ruling on emergency ex parte order"

"Took entirely too long to rule on an emergency case." **HARNETT**

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-judge-kimble/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED**Kaaneetha Morning**CPS WORKER · LENOIR · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

"Kaaneetha likes to degrade families and talk down to them like we are lesser of a person. She tries to turn every situation around to make the parent look bad. Since she became supervisor she has made my caseworker Shy-Kendra Lawson stop communicating with me completely and Kaaneetha has stopped all supervised visits with my children without a court order. She is disrespectful and has pushed for adoption and away from reunification since she started a few months ago. The last supervisor got up in the middle of work left everything at his desk, quit, and walked out. I believe that he couldn't go along with the orders he was being pushed to do to me. He had denied my visit on my baby's bday at first and then he called me the morning of my visit to tell me he was going to allow my visit after sleeping on it all night. He had started having compassion near the end and relating with me more and then he got up and just walked out and quit. Suspended my court-ordered visits with my children and told me visits would not resume unless I completed a hair follicle test, despite my prior negative drug screens and no new court order being shown to me. She is so unprofessional and acts ghetto!! Kaaneetha Morning informed me my visits were suspended, which further delayed reunification and caused continued separation from my children. She is really rude and degrades me every chance she gets."

"Restricted my visitation, ignored evidence and concerns I raised, and supported continued separation from my child in foster care. Was rude and tried degrading me every chance she got."

"Li3s, under oath, tampered srugs screena, not baving children's best interests at forefront"

"Saying I cannot been delivering with my daughter and being and cannot get my kids up"

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-kaaneetha-morning/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED**Matthew Jackson**ATTORNEY · BEAUFORT · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

"Submitted lies to the judge to obtain a non secured custody order. Gave documentation to him to show he d made an error which he refused to correct because his social workers would not give him false information. Interviewed children without anyone else present. Told my son he would never see me again if he changed his story. Threatened me directly saying I could keep fighting the allegations but I was only making it harder on the children because I would never see them and would be severely restricted in my contact with them, which they did until I got louder and louder and making complaints with the state and making TikTok's. Would not authorize my son's picture to be released to news outlets when he ran away from placement for the 4th time and was missing two months. Help suppress evidence and threatened law enforcement with law suites that were trying to help my son as he claimed physically and sexual assault by the facility he was placed in without a court order." **BEAUFORT COUNTY**

"He was the DSS attorney and reported falsely to the judge statements he said I made. Said the workers would not lie and that I was just changing my story now. I told him the statement Abby Williams made me write n that I was in a locked room. He said I just don't believe that but he still submitted that letter as fact. He told a judge I was fearful of my parents and that was a lie. He told a judge there was no one else to take me also a lie proven by many letters my mother has that she submitted to him from herself and my family. He also tried to block me from speaking with the judge."

"Has lied continuously, his court interpretations are quite warped and it's alarming he is still allowed to practice law without a serious psychological evaluation. MANY families have grievances with him. He has enabled the abuse of my children and acts as though he's untouchable. He throws tantrums when the judges don't do exactly what he wants, I've actually seen him storm out of the courtroom and I've also seen him so mad he started to pack up his belongings as the judge was still speaking. I have several pages of complaints against this one."

"Continues to delay my case. It's been a year without an initial hearing yet."

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-matthew-jackson/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Regina Parker

JUDGE · BEAUFORT COUNTY · 4 SUBMISSIONS

"She blindly signed nonsecured custody orders for me and my brothers. She would accept none of my mother's proof or documents. When I ran away she signed an order stating she was not requiring house arrest or monitoring but DSS was requesting it and they continued to have custody of me even tho I was 17 and the law says I can stay or go anywhere I feel is safe. My charges for undisciplined youth (running away) was dropped because of this law but that is still wrote in the order. I was led to believe I had been ordered by her and DSS but didn't see this order until I was already 18 as they would not allow me to have a copy of the order. I did ask. Due process was not followed or the law." **BEAUFORT**

"Signed a non secured custody order after DSS had taken the children but verified none of the statements in the motions nor spoke directly with any social worker or parent. When I made complaints from that time she has refused to touch our case nor hear anything to do with our case after I made a TikTok exposing she signs 94 % of all dss orders never verifying one thing or speaking with anyone other than dss attorney Matthew Jackson whom she has close ties with in the community on various projects."

"She's the chief district judge and not only did she lie to me she has enabled this abuse."

"Signed for telephonic signatures after the fact of removal."

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-regina-parker/complaint-packet>

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Robert S. Pleasant

ATTORNEY · JOHNSTON · 4 SUBMISSIONS

"I was there the entire day for a hearing and got the last five minutes of the day. I gave evidence that I was in the emergency room the day before with my son to prove that I was telling the truth. This attorney just came in there talking about he was in the emergency room with his dad, but was not required to have any proof. He just walked in and said it should be dismissed. The judge looked over the paper and dismissed it without hearing my evidence."

"Opposing counsel represented the children's father throughout the custody and child welfare proceedings. I am including this attorney because of their direct involvement in litigation, motions, court proceedings, and decisions that contributed to the ongoing separation from my children."

FAMILY COURT

"Failed to file a motion to modify a pre trial order after consultation with client during mediation resulting in tens of thousands of dollars lost."

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/nc-robert-s-pleasant/complaint-packet>

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Public threshold rule: Names are grouped conservatively by normalized spelling, role, and location. Common titles, punctuation, casing, and middle initials collapse together. Close misspellings are not auto-merged without admin review. Only family-direct submissions count toward the public threshold.

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

NORTH CAROLINA AT A GLANCE.

Across 215 North Carolina families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 384 214 of 215 families reported child counts	MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN \$140,000 median across 71 families reporting 3+ categories	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 17 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 51.2% 110 of 215 who answered; 77 of 215 ran out of money
SUBMISSIONS 215	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 1.8	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN 214 of 215	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 64

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so North Carolina families — and families across every represented location — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

03 THE COST OF NORTH CAROLINA FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	126	\$13,000	\$74,999	\$9,449,914
Lost Wages	94	\$10,000	\$87,955	\$8,267,801
Other Court Fees	50	\$2,750	\$16,980	\$849,000
Therapy / Evaluations	77	\$2,000	\$7,338	\$565,030
Reunification Services	46	\$450	\$2,353	\$108,240
GAL Fees	34	\$0	\$3,865	\$131,420
Asset Loss ¹	79	\$69,000	—	—
Median Family Burden (71 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	\$140,000	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least \$1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$69,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost		17	1.4 yrs
Mean months lost		33	2.8 yrs
Total across all families		5,254	437.8 yrs

04 WHO IS REPORTING · NORTH CAROLINA

Most families documenting in North Carolina are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children. Percentages below use only families who answered that specific topic.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed		107	50%
Case closed: within last 2 years		36	17%
Not provided		25	12%
Not in court but still affected		15	7%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago		15	7%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS		101	47%
Family Court Only		71	33%
CPS Only		25	12%
Unknown		18	8%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		64	30%
3 – 5 years		35	16%
5 – 10 years		34	16%
Over 10 years		26	12%
6 months – 1 year		25	12%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access		50	23%
Visitation Only		49	23%
50/50 Joint		46	21%
Children in Foster Care		31	14%
Full Custody		20	9%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Wake		16	9%
Johnston		12	6%
Mecklenburg		12	6%
Lenoir		11	6%
Buncombe		10	5%
Beaufort		9	5%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)		67	31%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)		41	19%
High Conflict Divorce		34	16%
Other		25	12%
Other: (Short answer)		9	4%

05 PARENT VOICES — NORTH CAROLINA

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable North Carolina comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.



Biased and fraud investigation from CPS Trumanda Raines has ruined me as a father to my kids from almost 8yrs.

— MICHAEL

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

My ex made false allegations which led (With the recommendation and advice give by CPS) to the no contact ex parte order of my child without any hearing or trial be held. Also, Corruption and Harrasement within the county caused constitutional laws to be broken.

— NORTH CAROLINA PARENT · AARON

MORE VOICES FROM NORTH CAROLINA

Decades of lost time, legal abuse, financial abuse, and emotional abuse to those that were the victims of domestic violence. Silence is death do not stop fighting for your children no matter the threats or the attacks because God will help you stand for justice.

— AMY

The Family Court and CPS system unlawfully and viciously destroyed my children and myself through fraud, lies, and incentives for profit. Family court literally destroyed everything that mattered to me and is still participating with state sponsored abuse.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They destroyed my family abused my children and sold them for bonuses and profit from me and adopted them out to strangers

— AIMEE

I can not put a dollar amount on what has been done. I'm currently fighting to keep my home, and I am not able to find a job that I'm qualified for due to false charges that the attorneys and judge's refuse to dismiss due to lack of evidence. Due to the false charge it is more [...]

— SARAH

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



The system has systematically torn apart our loving family under the guise of ‘best interests of the children,’ while the court and DSS—driven by profit, not justice—have violated our constitutional rights, ignored documented corruption and perjury, and now illegally demand that [...]

— JENNETTE

The Buncombe Co family law system and schools failed to protect me from an abuser that kidnapped my daughter from me. I suffer greatly emotionally on a daily basis dealing with the pain of losing my daughter and the false accusations. I suffer from bouts of intense depression [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Cumberland County has severely traumatized myself and my children my allowing this abuse to continue for over two years. They have caused me to develop severe CPTSD.

— APRIL

The corrupt family court system has enabled the mother of my children to keep my children away from me for the last 6 years and has caused unimaginable pain for them and myself and has stolen years that we will never get back!

— GAVIN

The system has completely tore my family apart. Leaving my kids in a home full of chaos and abuse. We are beyond traumatized.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Completely ignores other possible family members to place the children so they can keep them in custody. Violation of Rights Under Color of Law

— DERREKA

There were constant threats of making my life miserable if i ever left . However Never in a million years did I ever think with my ex knowing his status of being sterile he would attempt to kidnap my child with the courts help much less get away with it. using the courts to gain [...]

— ANITA

They took my life away. My husband and mother both committed suicide over the lose. I morn my children everyday and they are still alive

— ANGEL

CPS allows physical and verbal abuse on mothers along with selling my children through child trafficking. That is not child safety, that is abuse on our children and mothers.

— ALLISON

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



DSS with the help of my immigrant ex-wife not able to speak english the case worker fabricated false statements to build a case against me destroying our family. A corrupt evil DSS supervisor in charge said to me you did something wrong. DSS/JUDGE/GAL threaten brainwashed [...]

— FEDERICO

It has destroyed my kids. Plan and simple while leaving me broke from just trying to be a dad.

— JP

Ripped my world away broke my heart because I'm seeing now my children are suffering and being neglected from their own father.

— AMANDA

My kids have already lost one parent. Now cps is helping them lose another. This is inhumane

— LEAH

They destroyed the life my children and I had. I now have no life with my children.

— STEPHANIE

The court has destroyed my family and my children childhood and mental well being.

— CATHY

Lenoir county DSS came into our lives with the notion that they were there to help us rebuild after a brutal and traumatic experience. Instead, they came in and completely ripped my family apart. Slandered my name and character. Caused my kids emotional, mental, and even [...]

— SYDNI

Judge was horrible- would not listen, finalized order that put me out of house and home. And my kids best interest not considered in the slightest.

— JENNIFER

Ripped us into shreds, torn us.. broken us.. hurt us so badly. Traumatized my children to where they NEEDED therapy & things they NEVER needed PRIOR. Yet they use that as reason to KEEP THEM. Altered my records & my husband's, demanding things from our jobs which caused us to be [...]

— BRITTANY

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Taken my children's mother away with judges that won't make decisions and forensic interviews that are never read. I feel like nobody cares but me.

— VALERIE

This system has destroyed the soul of a child, her father's grief cannot be put into words, our children have missed out on months, if not years of having their own parents mentally healthy due to the stress and trauma, they have endured trauma of their own due to living with a [...]

— ERIN

Abused my child, incarcerated me twice, made me pay opposing counsel fees, denied me a court appointed attorney for Contempt, took my child away, retaliated.

— JACQUELYN

Ruined innocent childrens minds & bodies for money, control, & retaliation for standing on rights. We lost everything without one accountable accusation, still no court hearing, even if one it's rigged I have evidence it's already predetermined...

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I faced the unimaginable when trying to protect my children from harm. Over 900 days of separation after 5 years and 100 court hearings.

— SAPPHIRE

They took my kids for false report and now I'm gonna go to court Tuesday the 16 and I was told I was gonna get unsupervised visit but not they asking for me to have supervised visit

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They lost my son, he has been missing since September 23, 2025. They have consistently tried to cover up the unconstitutional seizure of my children. They scrubbed reports and gave my 8 year old daughter to our abuser and placed my 15 year old daughter with a pedophile.

— JESSICA

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Brunswick NC is corrupt county And they stole my children and made up Lies about my family with no proof of Anything happens to my children it was all false allegations and when I went to the group test and I passed it they said I had to see my children And then I go to see my [...]

— TAMMY

Family court has enabled and allowed my abuser to continue his abuse and destroy the life of my children and I. I am the only one fighting for the rights of my children while they suffer, psychologically, emotionally and behaviorally. It is the most traumatic experience I have [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has allowed financial abuse and intimidation that put me in crippling debt without any acknowledgement or repercussions by the Judge of my ex's purposeful stunts to increase my legal bills.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The North Carolina Family Court system, particular those actors in Union County, has consistently violated rights and broken the law, to the point of Erin Hucks, Stephen Higdon, and Wendy Maynard destroying evidence, and various actors enforcing jail time and false protective [...]

— WARREN

Due to the emergency case being drug out for entirely too long, there has been lost time with the child. The system has proved to be incredible corrupt with this judge and attorney.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I lost everything. My marriage, my children, my identity, my family, my peace, my health. My reputation. My belongings and home. I was diagnosed with permanent hip injury, PTSD, Adjustment Disorder from all that.

— SARAH

My boys that I raised alone were instantly ripped from their mother and have been told horrible untrue things about me to try and turn them against me. After domestic violence testimony and tons of evidence the judge still took my babies.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

158 North Carolina parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 38 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — NORTH CAROLINA

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from North Carolina families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

Biased and fraud investigation from CPS Trumanda Raines has ruined me as a father to my kids from almost 8yrs.

— MICHAEL

Decades of lost time, legal abuse, financial abuse, and emotional abuse to those that were the victims of domestic violence. Silence is death do not stop fighting for your children no matter the threats or the attacks because God will help you stand for justice.

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The Family Court and CPS system unlawfully and viciously destroyed my children and myself through fraud, lies, and incentives for profit. Family court literally destroyed everything that mattered to me and is still participating with state sponsored abuse.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They destroyed my family abused my children and sold them for bonuses and profit from me and adopted them out to strangers

— AIMEE

My ex made false allegations which led (With the recommendation and advice give by CPS) to the no contact ex parte order of my child without any hearing or trial be held. Also, Corruption and Harrasement within the county caused constitutional laws to be broken.

— AARON

I can not put a dollar amount on what has been done. I'm currently fighting to keep my home, and I am not able to find a job that I'm qualified for due to false charges that the attorneys and judge's refuse to dismiss due to lack of evidence. Due to the false charge it is more difficult to support my children while they're in custody, but I believe that this was the plan.

— SARAH

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The system has systematically torn apart our loving family under the guise of 'best interests of the children,' while the court and DSS—driven by profit, not justice—have violated our constitutional rights, ignored documented corruption and perjury, and now illegally demand that I abandon my own home for six months to a year as a condition for reunification, forcing us to choose between our rights and our children! UNITED WE STAND AND UNITED WE FIGHT!

— JENNETTE

The Buncombe Co family law system and schools failed to protect me from an abuser that kidnapped my daughter from me. I suffer greatly emotionally on a daily basis dealing with the pain of losing my daughter and the false accusations. I suffer from bouts of intense depression, anxiety, and PTSD. The supposed 'helpers' were all happy to take my money in the thousands, until I went bankrupt while lying to me saying they could help. In reality the system drew a further wedge between my daughter and I, resulting in no contact. I am left feeling like a victim of abuse with no assistance and zero support. I have been severely traumatized, humiliated, embarrassed, and financially ruined. I will probably never see my daughter again. It is the worst pain you could ever feel or imagine. The family court system in Buncombe Co is atrociously slow and fails to protect families and children. The Buncombe Co school system allowed my ex and daughter to violate a court order. Therapists and mediators also failed to address anything pertinent that actually could've helped my case. Everyone completely abandoned me and neglected to listen to me and my concerns. Now my two daughters are separated and will never know each other or have a bond. Ultimately it is the children who suffer the most, because adults fail at their jobs and fail at being decent human beings.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Cumberland County has severely traumatized myself and my children by allowing this abuse to continue for over two years. They have caused me to develop severe PTSD.

— APRIL

The corrupt family court system has enabled the mother of my children to keep my children away from me for the last 6 years and has caused unimaginable pain for them and myself and has stolen years that we will never get back!

— GAVIN

The system has completely tore my family apart. Leaving my kids in a home full of chaos and abuse. We are beyond traumatized.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Completely ignores other possible family members to place the children so they can keep them in custody. Violation of Rights Under Color of Law

— DERREKA

There were constant threats of making my life miserable if i ever left . However Never in a million years did I ever think with my ex knowing his status of being sterile he would attempt to kidnap my child with the courts help much less get away with it. using the courts to gain coercive control, custody of a child he knew wasn't his. These people have ruined me, my family perspective on fair and equal justice. Left to suffer in silence ,captivity my son physical, mental and psychological trauma from this nightmare will have longterm impact well into adulthood. This system has destroyed my children bonds , a sense of being whole and our family bond. Causing unnecessary, undeserving stress, Confusion and great distrust with this grave travesty of justice,division of our family causing daily emotional struggles

— ANITA

They took my life away. My husband and mother both committed suicide over the lose. I morn my children everyday and they are still alive

— ANGEL

CPS allows physical and verbal abuse on mothers along with selling my children through child trafficking. That is not child safety, that is abuse on our children and mothers.

— ALLISON

DSS with the help of my immigrant ex-wife not able to speak english the case worker fabricated false statements to build a case against me destroying our family. A corrupt evil DSS supervisor in charge said to me you did something wrong. DSS/JUDGE/GAL threaten brainwashed tortured my wife and child putting the baby child into foster care because my wife wanted to correct the written allegation she had wrote and copy from DSS in english. Note: My wife could not read, speak or write in english. Total family destruction not repairable..

— FEDERICO

It has destroyed my kids. Plan and simple while leaving me broke from just trying to be a dad.

— JP

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Ripped my world away broke my heart because I'm seeing now my children are suffering and being neglected from their own father.

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The court has destroyed my family and my children childhood and mental well being.

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Lenoir county DSS came into our lives with the notion that they were there to help us rebuild after a brutal and traumatic experience. Instead,they came in and completely ripped my family apart . Slandered my name and character. Caused my kids emotional, mental, and even physical trauma throughout this case . And they have done this unlawfully, illegally, and maliciously.

— SYDNI

Judge was horrible- would not listen, finalized order that put me out of house and home. And my kids best interest not considered in the slightest.

— JENNIFER

Ripped us into shreds, torn us.. broken us.. hurt us so badly. Traumatized my children to where they NEEDED therapy & things they NEVER needed PRIOR. Yet they use that as reason to KEEP THEM. Altered my records & my husband's, demanding things from our jobs which caused us to be let off. Adding charges to records we don't have. Slandering our names badly. It's ruined our life's completely. My kids didn't even get a chance at life..

— BRITTANY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Taken my children's mother away with judges that won't make decisions and forensic interviews that are never read. I feel like nobody cares but me.

— VALERIE

This system has destroyed the soul of a child, her father's grief cannot be put into words, our children have missed out on months, if not years of having their own parents mentally healthy due to the stress and trauma, they have endured trauma of their own due to living with a sibling with undiagnosed reactive attachment from all she has experienced, we have all lost opportunities that would have been life changing, & we went without so much, from a dependable car, let alone a second car, or a nicer place to live due to the amount of money we have to delegate to this. Presently we are in a financial hole due to the mental health needs resulting in residential stays that only we are paying for, plus now having to hire an attorney again.

— ERIN

Abused my child, incarcerated me twice, made me pay opposing counsel fees, denied me a court appointed attorney for Contempt, took my child away, retaliated.

— JACQUELYN

Ruined innocent childrens minds & bodies for money, control, & retaliation for standing on rights. We lost everything without one accountable accusation, still no court hearing, even if one it's rigged I have evidence it's already predetermined...

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06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

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— JESSICA

Brunswick NC is corrupt county And they stole my children and made up Lies about my family with no proof of Anything happens to my children it was all false allegations and when I went to the group test and I passed it they said I had to see my children And then I go to see my children here come to deputy sheriff's I went to prison for something I didn't do I took a plea for something I didn't do it I was innocent all because I didn't know how to do and I didn't believe that you would get locked up for something you didn't do The caseworkers were liars They told my children we died in a car accident and I was not able to see much of them or have it from years I had to make a breakdown Mentally I was unable to deal with it and I had to start seeing a therapist

— TAMMY

Family court has enabled and allowed my abuser to continue his abuse and destroy the life of my children and I. I am the only one fighting for the rights of my children while they suffer, psychologically, emotionally and behaviorally. It is the most traumatic experience I have ever been put through, more so, than losing both parents to cancer.

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Due to the emergency case being drug out for entirely too long, there has been lost time with the child. The system has proved to be incredible corrupt with this judge and attorney.

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I lost everything. My marriage, my children, my identity, my family, my peace, my health. My reputation. My belongings and home. I was diagnosed with permanent hip injury, PTSD, Adjustment Disorder from all that.

— SARAH

My boys that I raised alone were instantly ripped from their mother and have been told horrible untrue things about me to try and turn them against me. After domestic violence testimony and tons of evidence the judge still took my babies.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family court was a nightmare that felt as though it would never end. It nearly killed me. It tore our family apart and left my daughters (both) destroyed with PTSD on top of the abuse their father did to them- then family court punished them even further.

— JENNIFER

Compete and utter destruction and trauma along with PTSD. Allowing a Narcissist to almost destroy my kids by trying to emotionally, financially and physically ruin me.

— JENNIFER

This system didn't just fail my family — it systematically punished me for protecting my children, tore them from their mother, and caused irreversible trauma under the guise of 'justice.' What was done to us wasn't protection; it was sanctioned harm.

— HOLLY

The system has caused irreversible trauma and stress. There have been delays on plans for our family and home renovations.

— STEVEN

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

They have destroyed our family! Gave my boys to a monster who is in jail awaiting trial for unaliving my oldest son n now my 2 other boys are back in state custody with no contact. I was always supposed to be kept in thier lives . This was a reunification case not adoption !

— FELICIA

has gave him temp custody he has no car no job etc and i moved back judge won't grant a ex parte even thou he could be in another state kids haven't talked me in 3 n half weeks . i been back since dec 12 still haven't seen them. oh and the 6yr old supposed have started school.

— TAYLOR

It has taken our babies an destroyed our lives, an made 2 little girls suffer unimaginable horrors, with no intentions of re-uniting

— KATRINA

Stole my life and ruined my children

— DONNELLA

The broken system has broken my family and destroyed my childrens emotional well being that years of therapy won't ever truly heal all because I just wanted help, I wanted dad held accountable for DV.

— SHANNON

Taken my kids from a happy, healthy home. With a regular schedule. To a neglectful, abusive environment. Taken my health due to loss of livelihood. Forced us to endure abuse.

— BROOKE

I have personally seen Holly do everything she can to advocate for herself and her children, only to feel silenced and treated unfairly. I have seen the damage caused by the system and how much the separation from her girls have hurt her in many ways.

— STACEY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

My family was torn apart and all the trama and lies and hurt myself and kids have had to endure is so wrong

— COURTNEY

CPS took advantage of my depression and used it as a tool for attempted murder! Completely annihilated my family.

— NICOLE

No due process from a cheating spouse, quick Absolute-Divorce within months (lied about timeframe). Created hostile environment after divorce and used false allegations and “mean words” to secure DVPO; limiting access to son. Alienation has been used to make some hate his father with “he’s not safe”

— SHAUN

Ripped it apart. Took a part of me away and ill never be the same until i get them back

— ERICA

Avery county department of social services have destroyed my entire life for their financial gain. They never had our families best interest and defnately not my children's

— CARRIE

Family Court and Cps knowingly placed my child in the arms of a violent abuser who then committed crimes against her so heinous he's in prison for a decade. Only a fraction of time compared to the life long psychological trauma that she will have to endure. They robbed me of my baby because I refused to stop trying to protect her.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The rulings profoundly altered my children’s lives, leaving our family feeling unheard, unprotected, and forever changed.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

My children were wrongly taken from me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have robbed me and my children of precious time we will never get back

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Our girls not being with us has completely devastated us. All the money spent and continued to be spent could have been used for them and their education. Corrupt Judges and court officials need to be held accountable.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has terrorized and tormented me psychologically and emotionally for over 10 years. It has taken my parental rights, my human rights, my civil rights, and my constitutional rights. I have no rights to my children other than “visitation”, supervised at one point.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Loss of time with child. Loss of job traumatizing to child and family

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Franklin county has destroyed my family and my marriage, they are making me choose between my kids and my husband and trying to substantiate over something that never happened and my kids say never happened.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

As a stay at home mom who gave everything I have been destroyed to learn that the system is not designed to protect women from abuse. The person with the most money wins and everyone is looking for a payday from you. I would have been better off if my ex had cheated on me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

In my high conflict custody/support case, the Judge admitted evidence of wrongdoing then sanctioned me for showing crimes/misconduct of opposing counsel because I was harassing him. Opposing counsel started dating the Defendant, got suspended for 2yrs and has been on felony bail for 3 years with 30+ criminal records. I drained my entire life savings, lost a 4M business, came close to losing my freedom and my relationship with my kids has suffered greatly. The Bar says 'even if true, wouldn't violate their rules' the Attorney General says talk to the bar, local police defer to the bar, District Attorneys and every other attorney refuses to sue another attorney.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Every government board im there to speak for justice. I been put in jail, charged and retailiated against for telling this veterans story

— JERRY

This system re-traumatized myself and my children in an unnecessarily cruel manner that one would never anticipate experiencing in a democratic, law-abiding society.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

all the judges and lawyers work together in johnston county,

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system took my children, our time, our milestones, and our peace, while forcing me to fight to prove the love and bond that never should have been questioned. I want people to know that family separation is not just a court case, it is lifelong harm to children and parents.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This has cost my parents their retirement savings. They will now have to work until they die because the judge did not handle it in a reasonable or even remotely timely manner. It has cost my sister and her children a lot of trauma and sadness over the last year because the judge showed favoritism. It is absolutely mind boggling that the case when the way it did. Unheard of.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Mrs peacock of peacock family practice is the main bad actor in this whole affair. Because of her I have lost many a nights sleep.

— CLAUD

Ruined the foundation of a loving Mom and her children's safety in this world. Total loss of trust in an judicial system.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has torn my family apart. My children are the ones completely suffering and no one is helping them.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I don't feel like I can get a fair hearing in this county when the judge that's been assigned to my case that shown so much bias.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Separated children from the place they were born and loved. Alienated them and made me chose work or visitation. Lost my job. More alienation.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system is coming to my home and in my life and myself and my children and have completely changed our spirits our personalities and the way we view life. We won't constantly in fear everyday not knowing if we're going to be separated or what we're going to be facing if we're going to be sexually assaulted or stolen from each other. We now live life constantly in fear with a broken hearts and not knowing what the future holds unable to trust anyone or anything.

— SARA

The system has stolen time and been completely unjust to my child, my family and myself, and not doing what is best for the minor child's interest.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It has ripped our family apart and gave my kids to foster families where theybe been molsted and tried to tell me they were doing whats best for my kids...i wanted to make them go thru what they made my kids and i go thru really but wven tho have wronged us so bad im not that kinda person. They robbed us of hope and a futur together.

— EMILY

They stole my children my home tore apart everything I worked for used my past against me as weapon and my emotional vunerlabilty as a weapon and threaten they would get adopted out in the next trial if I did not sign my rights over.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Parental Allination, Fraser accusations, things were said to the child that weren't true,narcissist abuser

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My son rarely sees some of his siblings. It has absolutely taken away a lot of should be memories.

— CHRISTINE

The system has destroyed our way of life and made life a struggle for us because we are forced to spend time with and have to co-parent with our abuser. He continues to emotionally and verbally abuse our daughters and attempts to do the same to me. Luckily years of counseling has taught me how to ignore his attempts. I have been forced to stay in a state with no family or support system. My health has greatly suffered from all the stress. I have an autoimmune disease that will never go away and will haunt me for the rest of my life because of the way he treated me and our girls. He took something from me that I can never get back despite tons of evidence that the judge refused to look at. I was never given any post separation support despite being a dependent spouse for 12 years so my credit was ruined and I struggled financially for years and am still trying to recover from the financial destruction he has caused me. Our daughters are teenagers now and very angry. They were forced to go from the life they knew to a total opposite change of what they knew literally over night. The stress they went through and are continuing to experience is horrible and so unfair to them.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

They tore my children out of a loving safe home.... This distorted my whole life.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Hell right here on earth every second of every day non stop torture

— JENNIFER

The system openly ignored the fact that my children were being exposed to Marijuana - being used in front of children in an illegal state, unhealthy living conditions, unsafe sleeping arrangements and had a lack of proper hygiene and grooming, to keep the children in a town their "entire lives were spent in" the oldest was 5. The judge simple ignored all evidence due to the fact I was planning to move to a different state were both myself and them would have family support.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Turns out "family court " forgot the family part . Best interest of the child" sounds good, but in practice, it can feel like budgets and procedure matter more than children's actual needs. We lived the gap between the slogan and the reality. Children deserve more than a slogan .

— BECKA

Caused depression and PTSD, living in constant flight or fight

— TAMEKA

Taken my child through an emergency order riddled with false allegations and indicated she was adaptable for placement families....held her in cps custody over 1 year with still no hearing to date

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This is not a system to protect children, it is a system of lies and manipulation to obtain funds which ever way they can extort it!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I understand I made a mistake, but I never abused my kid. I have missed out on so much because he got taken at 3 & 1/2 months & is now 14 months.. he's my first... so I've missed out on actually being his mom

— REBA

The system has torn my family apart

— STACY

Family court did not protect my child or my family. It prolonged conflict, drained our finances, and cost us years of irreplaceable time together.

— NICOLE

They have lied numerous of times they have disrespected me too many times they removed my babies from me because my two year old got killed in the baby sitter care. They have interfered with my work life my personal life going against rules and regulations. They said they were waiting on the autopsy for my baby. They have it now and still no movement or progress. They still letting the babysitter roam around and they got all proof my two year old was with the babysitter they kept my son in a bad place instead of sending him home where he needs to be. They took my newborn from me after they stated someone could move with me until the autopsy came back and they left my newborn in the hospital for 2-3 weeks. The nurses were treating me like crap because of CPS. The detective said she needed to get a specialized doctor after the autopsy came to see exactly what home my baby died and it states my baby was with the babysitter.

— JORDAN

The system tried to destroy and break our family simply for money because three of our children have disabilities they could cash in on. That same system tried to silence us l, paint us as liars, when the proof didn't match the story they were telling. WE WILL NEVER STOP TELLING OUR STORY!!! If we help and save just one other family it was not for nothing. We are together. Our family fights together. They chose the wrong ones. All of my children are home because our voices, our proof, MATTERED.

— JUANITA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This system has alienated me from my children and their lives. It has denied my children of their mother and the close relationship we once had. The system doesn't care about "the best interest" of the children, they care about continuing the cycle for profit. Judges are not held accountable for perjuring themselves. They say one thing and do another. This system is a joke.

— ALEXIS

The system put my child in the custody of an abusive grandparent who isolates her from me and other loving people

— MANDY

I have never experienced such heartbreak and distrust in individuals and a system built to protect children. NCDHHS should be appalled at the gross oversight and atrocities being committed.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have systematically degraded my relationship with my children, and enabled the parallel parent to alienate me and caused untold damage to the children resulting in mental health issues and prescriptions that are normally reserved for severe mental disorders.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This experience has left me carrying a level of grief that is difficult to put into words. I have spent nearly three years mourning children who are still alive, missing moments I can never get back, and living with a pain that follows me from the moment I wake up until I go to sleep. I'm no longer the same woman and my mental health is severely destroyed and struggling to maintain hope. I feel as if I no longer have a purpose in life and I'm not sure how much longer I can continue to hold on.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Scummy people doing scummy things!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This system is not about the best interest of the child, as this child lived in consistent danger for almost 10 years. Keep fighting for those children. The good old boy system is real in Gaston County.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Tore my family apart, I haven't seen my babies since 2017& 2018!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I have been separated from my children for over 5 years wrongfully through a conspiracy between DSS and law enforcement. The judges and DSS purposely drag a case out for as long as possible and are always against reunification even when there is absolutely no evidence to support a lawful separation while knowing the devastating effects it is having on the children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I have missed moments with my baby that I will never get back, and the pain of being separated from my child has affected every part of my life. I want people to know that parents and children should not be torn apart without real evidence, fairness, and due process.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It brought us back together better than ever.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has stole my natural right as a mother to build bond with child qnd the wmoational stress on the children and the mother.. in the be batudal qorkd what effecta does it have on aby other mother that has its baby taken or hurt...

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I have learned that the truth does not prevail. The only thing that prevails is the agenda and that is done at any cost. My children are now alienated from me; essentially they have nothing to do with me. During the three years DSS kept this case open with no services my son (14) became addicted to drugs, selling drugs, went from A/B honor roll to being on an IEP, both my kids got suspended from school, both became quite the experts at stealing from stores, my son had a sex tape that was leaked. The system annihilated my family!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The Charlotte North Carolina Court system is incredibly corrupt. They would rather standby a repeated felon, then help a victim with a lifetime domestic violence restraining order.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I escaped a high-demand religion over ten years ago, and I never expected to experience a similar level of fear, coercive control, grief, and loss of safety again. But my experience in 'family court' feels even more consuming and devastating to me personally. I felt pulled into a system with layers of authority and gatekeepers that consumed more than \$90,000 in legal fees, cost me substantial assets and income, disrupted my relationship with my children, and has left me emotionally and financially exhausted. I want people to understand that families are not just losing cases — many are losing years of their lives, financial stability, health, and relationships with their children while trying to survive a process they never expected to have to navigate. Based on my experience, I believe families need far safer, more accountable alternatives than the current family court system, because seeking help should not leave protective parents and children more vulnerable than before. Law enforcement also does NOT protect women or children in my experience as a mother.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system is not fair, and I believe he say should not be taken into account without proper documentation. I see a weird perspective on mothers nowadays that can be detrimental to the children and lawyers are very lazy now in this generation..

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Randolph county CPS has tore my family apart has made me sicker than I can even imagine to tell you has put a breaking point between me and my daughter and my husband our family is gone because of them and I can't trust the law or the judicial system that I grew up thinking they knew what they were doing and that they believed in truth

— TERRI

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

My high conflict ex has accused me of multiple types of abuse and when I agreed to a full custody evaluation (\$20,000+), he dismissed the findings - no evidence of abuse against me but evidence of manipulation and lying from him.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Forced my autistic child to remain in custody of abusive ex because the court don't care

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Blamed me for suffering at the hands of my narcissistic ex and his flying monkeys. Has allowed the relationship between my kids and myself to be eroded in ways that I can't easily recover due to my economic disadvantage and made me the victim of further vexatious litigation to retaliate against me for perceived wrongs that are false.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This hasn't been the best year or set of seasons for us all. My husband and I have been separated over 11 months. My daughter is also been gone for over 11 months. The constant pressure of promises of Reunification is a constant disappointment and a plethora of other issues or reasons why we cannot reunite due to her mental health. I went through with not just already being a clean addict in a active recovery for 18 months and 23 days and go to Narcotics Anonymous, Co-Dependency Anonymous, Two Triple P Parenting Seminars, Several sessions with A Psychologist for a psychological evaluation. I went to Caldwell County Domestic Violence Abuse Education Zoom Classes, CPS Parenting Program provided for me for ARC Parenting Zoom Classes services, 2 hour visits supervised for the past 11 months and only a few unsupervised sessions with her and myself. Then meeting the Foster Parents halfway which gas is expensive for whatever that's worth and I'm on social security disability income which is not even close to enough to keep everything else in place and on time bill wise but I do my best.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I've witnessed a very unfair and concerning amount of corruption in this court room as a witness. I am deeply concerned for the justice system in this county and have lost faith in honorable decision making.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Destroyed our family, testimony should not be believed without evidence to support. Family court should be held accountable and rules changed to what is allowed- not who they believe more, Narcissist protect their image.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has caused my children to be scared of the government. Non-trusting of people and scared to develop relationships with good people. Also my son has been abused while in their custody and he is very angry and will cut people out of his life quickly. These were happy, well- adjusted, loving children, going through this has left scars no one can see but I can feel every day.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have made me lose so many first milestones with my son I've missed school pictures, yearbooks, first tooth, field day, dances, programs, Christmases. He's missed his brother's graduation.

— CHRISTINE

The Charlotte-Mecklenburg Judiciary has cost me over 6 years of an already horrific, adjudicated system of ABUSE. Irena Zarutka put this county on the map with it's bad behavior and sadly, that women, who lost her life has seemingly crossed over to a better place than this town. This town should be exposed for its injustice. (Is there an email I can provide with all of my story that I sent to ACLU?)

— KRISTEN

I was wrongful accused and DSS has no proof of allegations. My oldest daughter came home. But the youngest is still being alienated from me

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Severe prolonged psychological damage and traumatic mental health physical deterioration. PTSD, depression near death. Tremendous strain and stress near loss of external family. Word's can't describe. Death. Death of hope. Stroke, heart attack, seizures job loss reputation destruction online repetition slander reputation destruction resulting in joblessness and in a few weeks homelessness.

— TRAVIS

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Alienated me from constitutional fatherhood and the quiet enjoyment thereof

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Since my child has been in public schools I, have had multiple cases opened. I have even had multiple cases opened in the same week.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Completely tore apart

— HEATHER

Tried to rip us apart as in they tried to make my husband and I divorce told us that they had someone that wanted to adopt our children. We presume it was my in-laws because they've been trying to get me to sign my son over to them

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Multiple counties conspired together to destroy my home and peace of mind.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ruined our entire life!!!

— BRITHY

They stole my nephew.

— SANDRA

Former pissed off foster kid

— CHRIS

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Tore my family apart

— KYESHA

As a veteran who served this country honorably, it has been devastating to feel discarded by a system that I believe failed to hear me while I watched years with my children disappear. I believe the other parent hid behind military status and influence while I was left fighting to be recognized as a father, missing milestones and memories I can never get back.

— ROYDRICK

This entire debacle of a case has smeared myself and both my parents and every once in awhile siblings as a result of these false allegations. It is affecting my ability to work. To find work. TO be hired as a machinist/ PLC worker where my work experience rests in. It caused me to loose friends and allies along with creating spiritual attacks that have led me to become sort of like a pastor in order to combat those off. I am bullied when I go out in public, and people have mentioned that I should "wear a hat more".

— MIGUEL

Burke county CPS admitted to wrongdoing in my case, yet would never say what exactly. When I started filing motions demanding answers, they transferred my case to Catawba county so they wouldn't have to let me know exactly what wrongdoing they did, although I imagine it's everything in the entire case. The court papers I was first served with says my son is a 16 year old Guatemalan, however, he's a 2 year old Caucasian boy.

— MIRANDA

The family court system has broken my faith in the Anerican Justice system, hurt my mental health, my family's savings is gone letting mine and my childs abuser win absolutely everything. A man that hasn't seen or talked to his child in 2 years and hurt him has full and complete custody a man with 100% disability mostly from severe mental health.

— REBECCA

I have developed an autoimmune disorder. I have lost a ton of friends and hair. I have high blood pressure and trouble sleeping. I have started blood pressure medication and sleeping medicine. I'm only 31.

— TORI

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It has affected my mental and emotional state. I feel like I am losing hope and not being treated like a human being. My Son is my reason for everything and now that he is gone I feel like I have nothing left in this world.

— CHELSEA

Torn us apart. I completed everything they asked if me and more. Separated my boys into foster homes. My youngest is in group home misbehaving the whole time he's been in the system. I still have parental rights but I can see them or speak to them. October will be a year since I have spoken with them. I finally was able to get them to let me write them letters. I have had 25 caseworkers at this point.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My daughter is bonding with my mother for the last 4 months. This is a critical time for attachment development. Everyone involved including the safety provider and I'm nvestigator have said they know I am not a danger to Laken.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has made my children regress in certain developmental milestones. It has tore my family apart. My family havent been able to see my children for awhile now. I've missed so many important milestones for my children because of what DSS has done to me and my family. I just want my children home where they belong. Not for someone else to raise them.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Took our autistic nephew form is caused depression caused him to to sneek ways to communicate we have not seen or heard from him in 3 years HE WAS 8 2 DAYS FORM BEING 9 AND HE IS NOW 12

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I'm just here to be noseay

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I have been discarded from my son's life. I was trying to be a parent, the system chose to side with what a 17 year old wanted, to live with his "easier" parent and ignored my testimony.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The lies that were told and upheld in family court allowed my dad to win because he had all the money, and it cost us as teenagers to be forced to go live with him again after he was abusive to us through our childhood.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have violated my right to due process (not letting the court-ordered expert testify; when their report didn't align with their narrative). They violated my right to raise my children and be a part of their lives, which is protected under the 14th Amendment of the Constitution. They violated the 7th Amendment and executed involuntary servitude when they made me pay child support with no criminal record, no reason for termination of my time with children, and no benefit in paying. They subjected us all to more DV I talked to my daughter 12 times in 1 year and those were very brief calls, maybe 15 min at most. My son was neglected to the point of ICU admission, continual court hearings to prove things that were already proved because they don't want to ruin dad's military career.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I still have PTSD whenever I have to go to court about something, even to renew my drivers license. It was SEVEN years of reliving everything that happened in the three years we were together.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This dark, greedy, ego-driven system has crushed my children's innocence, obviated their ability to trust any adult, removed them from safety, and delivered them into the home of their predator. Instead of protecting my children from a manipulative, coercive, abusive parent, this system has invested its resources into gaslighting my young children and severing them from the only adult who has been brave enough to advocate for them in the face of years of threats and harm.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It destroyed me emotionally and psychologically. It destroyed the innocence of three little girls. It took them away from their families, their friends, their schools and their two brothers. Their grandfather had a stroke while all this was going on and his last wish was to get those girls home. He died, knowing that his granddaughters were in Foster Care being molested by a 40+ year-old man. It has destroyed my daughter emotionally and made her drug use hundred times worse. It has affected every single person in our family.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The prolonged proceedings in Duplin County have caused significant emotional and financial hardship for me over the years. The ongoing conflict and repeated court involvement have contributed to anxiety, stress, and instability for both myself and the minor child.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This custody battle has taught me that protecting children is not about winning against the other parent; it is about preserving stability, truth, and peace when conflict tries to rewrite the story. I will keep choosing documentation over drama, boundaries over bitterness, and my children's well-being over public revenge.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The court has caused undue emotional stress on my young child, and myself. Leading to my child self harming and acting out at school due to not wanting to be with her father despite the courts failure to acknowledge evidence

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The coordinated actions of these state and private actors mirror the elements of a federal criminal conspiracy (18 U.S.C. § 241) to deprive me & my daughter of our constitutional rights and exploited my family for pecuniary gain. I have meticulous documentation of these crimes, including the unlawful "self-help" eviction from my home and the theft of my personal property, perjury, obstruction of justice and stonewalling communication with me while working to ignore problems with other parent.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This system weaponized a son's choice against his family, imposing five years of baseless supervised visitation that fractured my relationship with my daughters despite there being no threat of danger.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My son who is taking college courses in highschool is a good kid but has to endure his father's rage episodes where he has been strangled, pushed and father held my son down on the ground with his foot, banged his head on the desk, and threatened since 11 he would go to a foster home if he told police the abuse he was getting.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has ruined my life I have PTSD and severe Depression I'm lost and have no purpose. My daughter's are having separation anxiety issues and my special needs daughter doesn't understand what happened but knows something isn't right and her medical needs are now a fight daily with my mother in law because I know what's best and what she needs. My girls love me and my oldest daughter asks me daily if I am working on it?... meaning am I going to bring the ones who hurt us to justice.

— BRITTANY

This system has not protected my child and has torn apart my entire family. They have never listened to my child and they have been openly biased, played favorites, and lied under oath. It's a very sad world when whoever has the most money is the only person listened to. My child is suffering major life long consequences and lives in fear daily.

— LESLIE

This system has nearly broken me as an individual. I have never understood how people could give up on life and commit suicide until going through this experience as well as have I never had the true feeling of hatred towards anyone in my entire life and it's been very difficult to not feel that way towards these actors and perpetrators

— DANIEL

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I trusted DSS with my first son. This time I gave temporary guardianship to my Aunt and allowed her to take my son to FL I am in NC DSS has harassed me all day demanding I tell her to bring him back so they can make sure he's safe. They claim they as of 9:30 pm have been granted custody. One of the case workers is Jessica she literally text me at 3 am and said they are going to have my Aunt arrested for kidnapping. There was no court order (and I have yet to see one) when she left I just know they can't be trusted.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system encouraged me to consent to a PC however gave me no choice in who I could use and has forced me to stay involved with AND pay a party who is clearly bias in regards to any interpretations of the order. I attempted to wait until the appointment was over rather than file motions to challenge PC decisions for the sake of peace and rather at a reappointment hearing, the PC was praised for keeping my family out of court. When I challenged that narrative the script was turned on me for not filing motions to challenge PC decisions. There is a documented pattern of preference. The PC substantially increased conflict in my family rather than lessen or resolve it.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

158 full approved North Carolina comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a public, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this North Carolina report comes from North Carolina respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in North Carolina — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 215 North Carolina families reporting here are not the universe of North Carolina families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. Response counts and percentages use the number of families who answered that specific topic or financial field. The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – July 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

Dollar fields exclude blank, negative, and obvious data-entry artifact values above the report's field caps. When asset-loss values contain a strong statistical outlier, the asset-loss mean and total are suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county or regional field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

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